

# Week 18 Lit Example Reader

## REVISING A SHAKESPEARE JUDGMENT

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**Purpose:** Practice a visible revision trail on familiar Shakespeare evidence before revising a portfolio artifact of your own.

**What to watch for:** A revision should preserve the original claim, diagnose one exact weakness, change the reasoning, and explain why the change matters.

### Before the Passages: The Week 18 Revision Tool

- **Recover:** identify the draft's claim, evidence, inference, and assumption.
- **Diagnose:** apply one fitting criterion to a precise feature.
- **Revise:** clarify, narrow, add support, or repair the connection.
- **Caption:** name the before-and-after change and the habit it shows.

### Passage 1: Macbeth, Act 4, Scene 1 — Security from a Promise

**Context:** Macbeth hears the second apparition promise that none “of woman born” shall harm him. He turns the promise into confidence about Macduff.

**Second Apparition.** Be bloody, bold, and resolute; laugh to scorn  
The power of man, for none of woman born  
Shall harm Macbeth.

**Macbeth.** Then live, Macduff: what need I fear of thee?  
But yet I'll make assurance double sure,  
And take a bond of fate: thou shalt not live.

### Assisted Revision Model

Suppose an early caption said: “Macbeth is fooled because the witches lie.” That claim notices danger but outruns the passage. The words are equivocal, yet the later plot gives them a technical fulfillment. A stronger diagnosis is that the caption treats deception as a simple false statement and misses Macbeth's inference from an ambiguous promise to practical certainty. A substantive revision would narrow the claim: Macbeth accepts the most reassuring sense, fails to test the source and terms, and then uses that confidence to justify further violence. The revision is stronger because it names evidence, a logical habit, and the exact point of failure.

**Reading task:** Underline the promise; circle Macbeth's inference; bracket the action he adds. In the model, mark the original claim, diagnosis, and revised claim.

### Annotation Notes

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## Passage 2: Julius Caesar, Act 2, Scene 1 — Possibility as Necessity

**Context:** Brutus has no present personal cause against Caesar. He imagines how a crown might change Caesar and reaches a preventive conclusion.

**Brutus.** It must be by his death: and for my part,  
I know no personal cause to spurn at him,  
But for the general. He would be crown'd:  
How that might change his nature, there's the question.  
...  
And therefore think him as a serpent's egg  
Which, hatch'd, would, as his kind, grow mischievous,  
And kill him in the shell.

### Reader Notes

This passage shifts the revision work to you. An early response might praise Brutus's concern for Rome or condemn him as simply wrong. Neither judgment is yet a logic analysis. Attend to the distance between *might change* and *must be by his death*, the work performed by the serpent's-egg analogy, and the alternatives or evidence left unexamined. Decide which criterion best diagnoses the early response; do not merely attach every course term.

**Reading task:** Underline the uncertain language. Box the conclusion of necessity. Star the analogy. In the margin, name one kind of support the argument still needs.

### How to Use These Passages on the Worksheet

Passage 1 demonstrates the shape of a revision trail. For Passage 2, preserve the early claim, diagnose one exact weakness, revise it with textual evidence, and write a caption that explains what the later Whately tool made visible.

### Transfer Notes

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